relations between states, and the Mossad, one of whose jobs is to maintain intelligence relations between Israel and other countries. In practice, however, the boundaries between intelligence issues and diplomatic issues are blurred. For various reasons, decision makers sometimes prefer to relay messages to each other via intelligence services and not through the foreign ministry. Moreover, to this day there are quite a few countries in the world that for various reasons do not want to have open diplomatic relations with Israel but maintain contact—sometimes intensive contact—through the intelligence channels.

In such cases, the Mossad representative responsible for this connection is a representative of the State of Israel for all intents and purposes, and not only regarding intelligence matters. The Mossad representative's presence in the foreign country, his or her dialogue with senior people and sometimes even with the country's ruler, gives the Mossad a real advantage in assessing these countries' intentions, the ability to warn of changes before any other party, and the ability to use the ties created in order to advance Israeli interests.

What are the decision makers' basic working assumptions when designing a system of intelligence? The *first working assumption* should be that intelligence sources are the most important asset and resource in the entire sphere of intelligence. The preservation of the sources' secrecy must be sacrosanct. The establishment of intelligence sources is the most difficult, time-consuming, and expensive aspect in the entire field of intelligence work. The damage caused from the exposing of sources has dire consequences for the system and the state. I believe that the principle of protecting sources must take precedence over any other consideration. In order to reassure those with whom you are providing the intelligence that it is indeed reliable, various mechanisms should be put in place to protect the identity of sources.

In the Yom Kippur War of 1973 we had a colossal failure of intelligence. After the war, a state commission of inquiry was established, headed by the president of the Supreme Court and comprising another Supreme Court justice, two former IDF chiefs of staff, and the state comptroller. I was serving as the Mossad operations officer at the time. I prepared the intelligence material for then-director of the Mossad Major General (reserve) Zvi Zamir's appearance before the commission. I attached two indexes to the material. The first gave full identification of all of the sources mentioned in